Vincent Chung

PhD Candidate in Environmental Economics
London School of Economics and Political Science
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Research Fields

Environmental Economics; Non-Market Valuation; Stated Preference Methods; Experimental Economics

Education

PhD in Environmental Economics, London School of Economics and Political Science **2023–present**
Thesis: *Advancing Stated Preference Methods with Virtual Reality* Expected 2027

MSc Environmental Economics and Climate Change, London School of Economics and Political Science **2017**
Distinction; Top Student in Environmental and Natural Resource Economics

BA Economics, University of Manchester **2016**
First Class Honours; Outstanding Academic Award (Top 0.5% of graduating cohort); Cobden Prize in Econometrics and Statistics

Research

Chung, V., Sotis, C., Smith, T., & Atkinson, G. *Seeing Is Believing, but Believing Is Not Paying More: A Field Experiment on Virtual Reality and Coral Reef Valuation.* **Job Market Paper**. [Latest Version]

Abstract: We conducted a randomised field experiment with 837 participants in Brisbane, Australia, comparing immersive virtual reality with text-and-image information about Great Barrier Reef degradation. VR increased spatial presence and reduced psychological distance, but produced no statistically robust effects on hypothetical willingness to pay, actual donations or immediate behavioural outcomes after adjustment for multiple testing. Mediation analysis suggested positive indirect effects on conservation engagement through reduced psychological distance, subject to identifying assumptions. Analyses in a smaller, self-selected follow-up sample suggested greater baseline-to-follow-up reductions in psychological distance, stronger behavioural intentions at one month and more conservation actions reported since the experiment. The findings show that immersive representation can change how environmental degradation is psychologically experienced without systematically increasing elicited monetary values.

Chung, V., Atkinson, G., & Smith, T. *Stated Preference Validity in the Age of Immersive Media: Evidence on Scope Sensitivity and Hypothetical Bias. Working Paper.* [PDF]

ECO-CHICA Collaborative Group (including **Chung, V.**). *Consensus Guidelines for the ECOnomiC Evaluation of the Health Impacts of Climate Action (ECO-CHICA): An Explanatory Overview.* Manuscript under review at *The Lancet Planetary Health.* [SSRN]

Sotis, C., Contu, D., Atkinson, G., Dussaux, D., Georgiou, S., Mourato, S., & **Chung, V.** *Valuing the Avoidance of IQ Losses in Children: A Large-Scale Multi-Country Stated Preference Approach. Working Paper.*

Contu, D., Sotis, C., Atkinson, G., **Chung, V.**, Georgiou, S., Dussaux, D., Mourato, S., & Hu, I. *Valuing a Reduction in the Risk of Skin Sensitisation: A Large-Scale Multi-Country Stated Preference Approach. OECD Environment Working Papers*, No. 277, OECD Publishing (2026). [OECD]

Sotis, C., Contu, D., **Chung, V.**, Atkinson, G., & Mourato, S. *Willingness-to-Pay to Ban Octocrylene. Working Paper.* Based on valuation work undertaken for the ANSES *Annex XV Restriction Report — Octocrilene.* [PDF]

Chung, V., Sotis, C., & Ma, J. *Synthetic Respondents for Environmental Valuation: Evidence from Open-Weight Large Language Models. Work in Progress.*

Chung, V. & Chung, W. *Learning through Immersion: A Randomised Experiment in Climate Education. Work in Progress.*

Applied Research Experience

OECD Environment **2024–2026**
Researcher / Co-author — SWACHE: Valuing Skin Sensitisation

French Agency for Food, Environmental and Occupational Health & Safety (ANSES) **2024**
Researcher — Economic Valuation of an EU Octocrilene Restriction

Teaching Experience

London School of Economics and Political Science **2024–present**
Graduate Teaching Assistant
MY464 Critical Data Literacy (MSc); *MY451A Introduction to Quantitative Analysis* (MSc); *GY120 Environmental Change* (Undergraduate).

Student evaluation scores: 4.9/5, 5.0/5, 5.0/5, 4.8/5, and 4.9/5 (mean: 4.92/5).

LSE GROUPS **2025**
Research Supervisor
Supervised a seven-student undergraduate research project; awarded Best Methodology Prize.

Teaching Qualifications

Postgraduate Certificate in Higher Education (PGCertHE) **2026**

Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (FHEA) **2026**

Funding and Awards

2026	**LSE Global School of Sustainability Research Grant**, £40,000 — Lead Researcher and Lead Grant Writer
2026	**LSE Global School of Sustainability PhD Student Grant**, £5,000
2024/25–2025/26	**LSE Students' Union Teaching Award**, Geography and Environment — Winner in both years
2023–present	**LSE PhD Data Science Studentship**, £180,000

Professional Experience

Singapore Armed Forces **2017–2023**
Head of Strategic Policy Section (Assistant Director) Singapore

- Led strategic policy analysis and prepared recommendations for senior government decision-makers.
- Directed long-term planning and cross-agency analytical work, including development of a six-year strategic roadmap.

Languages and Software

Languages: English (native); Mandarin Chinese (native); German (high-intermediate).

Software: R, Stata, Qualtrics, LaTeX, Unity, 3DVista, Insta360 Studio.

References

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